

Project Development Phase

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Item	Detail
Project	Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer
Platform	ServiceNow (Flow Designer, Service Catalog)
Phase	5 - Project Development
Purpose	Record how the solution is built in ServiceNow.

Milestone 1: Create the Flow

- 1 Open ServiceNow, click **All** and search for **Flow Designer**. Open it under Process Automation.
- 2 Click **New** and select **Flow**.
- 3 Set the flow name to **Standard Laptop Task**, Application to **Global** and Run as to **System User**. Click **Submit**.
- 4 Click **Add a trigger**, search for **Service Catalog**, select it and click **Done**. Limit it to the Standard Laptop item.
- 5 Under Actions, click **Add an action**, search for **Create Catalog Task** and select it.
- 6 Drag the **Requested Item** record into the Request Item field. The table fills in as Catalog Task.
- 7 Set Short description to **Laptop needs to be configured**.
- 8 Click **Add field value**: Description = **Laptop needs to be configured**; Assignment group = **Hardware**.
- 9 Leave the other fields as default and click **Done**.
- 10 Click **Save**, then **Activate**.

Milestone 2: Assign the Flow to the Catalog Item

- 1 Click **All** and search for **Maintain Items**.
- 2 Search the Name field for **Standard Laptop** and open the record.
- 3 Open the **Process Engine** tab. Remove the other automations.
- 4 Add the flow **Standard Laptop Task**.
- 5 Save the record.

Milestone 3: Order and Approve through Service Catalog

- 1 Click **All**, search **Service Catalog**, open **Hardware** and select **Standard Laptop**.
- 2 Click **Order Now**.
- 3 On the order status page, click the **Request Number**.
- 4 In the **Approvers** section, right-click the record and choose **Approve**.
- 5 Open the **Requested Item** and scroll to **Catalog Tasks**.
- 6 Open the task and check the short description and assignment group.

Configuration Summary

Setting	Value
Flow name	Standard Laptop Task
Application / Run as	Global / System User
Trigger	Service Catalog
Action	Create Catalog Task
Short description	Laptop needs to be configured
Description	Laptop needs to be configured
Assignment group	Hardware
Attached to	Standard Laptop (Process Engine tab)

Improvements over the Source Steps

Source step	Development change
Task created "after approval" but trigger fires on submission	Add an approval step before Create Catalog Task.
Task Approval field set to Approved	Removed; not needed.
Flow named two different ways	Standardised as Standard Laptop Task.
Text "Laptop need to Configured"	Corrected to "Laptop needs to be configured".

Scripted Implementation (Optional)

For instances where the flow is not built by hand, the project includes three background scripts: **01** sets up the Hardware group and Standard Laptop item, **02** installs the three business rules, and **03** places test orders and checks the results. Core logic of the task rule:

```
if (!current.approval.changesTo('approved')) return;
if (current.cat_item.getDisplayValue() != 'Standard Laptop') return;
// skip if a task already exists for this RITM
task.request_item = current.getUniqueValue();
task.short_description = 'Laptop needs to be configured';
task.assignment_group = <Hardware group>;
task.insert();
```